

Android and the US Army

US Army is calling Android developers to create and submit tactical Android apps using the military's CE Product Developers Kit

3.9 million units

That is the amount of Fusion APU units sold by AMD accounting for half of its laptop shipments in the past quarter

3D CONTENT

Videocon D2H is the only service offering 3D content. Of course, you will need a 3D TV to view the content. There is one Active 3D HD channel which broadcasts 3D content. We got to see some magic show from Singapore. Quality was quite decent. But frankly, how long can you view random 3D content on loop? Videocon needs to provide 3D content like 3D movies to impress. As a USP the 3D functionality is good, but then the true test will begin once we have 3D broadcast. We were not able to watch any 3D movie content being beamed from the satellite. We feel this technology on the STB is too early for the Indian market. It is pointless as well, as there is no 3D content being broadcast in India presently. Moreover, very few households have 3D TVs. It will still take some time before 3D goes mainstream as far as home viewing is concerned. One thing we absolutely hated in the 3D viewing experience was the stretching of the Videocon d2h logo across the centre of the screen. It can get very distracting.

Airtel recently announced its 3D plans while Tata Sky claims that it is "3D ready".

The user interface of d2h is very simple and somewhat boring to look at. While surfing channels you get a one line display of the currently playing program with the program guide extending to one more day. The other way to access channels is by pressing OK button on the remote control which will bring up a vertical list of channels, which you can enter individually to set reminders or to record. The Guide button takes you to a screen full of various genre of channels offered. There is a background music accompanying it, which is annoying. It has a small preview section once you select a particular genre.

We did notice some lag while changing channels similar to Dish TV Tru HD. The Menu button pulls up a menu screen on the left hand side which has direct icons for DVR, mosaic picture-in-picture (PIP), etc.. PIP gives you a visual layout of 12 different channels, while the video is running on all the screens, only the selected screen's audio will be audible.

We noticed a definite delay in populating the EPG when you select a particular genre from the Guide. As you press the down arrow key to load more channels, the EPG will still be loading unlike the quick EPG seen in Tata Sky+ HD even while channel surfing.



Videocon d2h 3D HD DVR was the only service provider which had an active 3D channel but 3D content needs to improve

You can set upto four users and have 20 channels per user. This is a great functionality as not all members in a family have the same favourite list.

Active services comprise D2h Movies, Active Games, Active Puzzle, Active Music, Direct Active, etc. Quality wise, they are strictly OK. Barring the D2h movies which is a pay channel, there isn't much to explore in this menu.

The remote control is well laid out with mild rubbery surface on the base. It has small round rubber buttons on the remote in the lower half, where as the topmost portion

has a range of shortcut keys like Active, Favourites, PIP, etc. It can control your STB as well as the TV. There is a purple button on the lower most tip of the remote which serves no purpose.

In Videocon d2h, the recording offers a variety of options such as starting or ending recording upto 30 mins earlier or later. This comes in handy when you are watching sports, like you want to hear the analyses after the football or cricket match, etc. The buffer can record upto 120 minutes ie. you can pause a live TV for upto that time. Like Tata Sky_ HD, it allows you to watch a recorded program while two programs are recording in the background.

Reliance Digital TV

Red and grey are the only prominent colours in the user interface of Reliance

channels that we were surfing did not have any data beyond a few hours on that day. The Select button opens up twelve picture-in-picture screens based on the channels. This is very similar to Videocon d2h Mosaic 12 PIP.

Getting to the genre based channel surfing option is a big pain. It does offer Favourites option. You can add upto eight profiles on Favourites, but accessing the favourite channels from the remote is a big pain. Another hitch we noticed with Reliance Digital TV was the slowing down of the user interface when we started recording. This is really bad and not desirable at all. On pressing the Interactive services button, you will have the 'Please wait, Application loading...' message on for over 10 seconds before it enters the menu. There is no option to set Reminders, which is shocking. Overall experience with the user interface was disappointing. We hope Reliance upgrades its firmware.

On live pausing, you will get an indication of the time elapsed since you have paused and then you can seek accordingly to arrive at the live timeline or just get rid of some ads that may have been recorded during a live pause.

You cannot record two programs on different channels at the same time. You will either have to stop

Reliance Digital TV had one of the most sluggish user interfaces amongst all the participants

